

WHY DO WE GET ANNOYED?

annoying = irritating = displeasing = frustrating = tiresome = infuriating = inconvenient = pesky = aggravating



Check (✓) the annoyances that are listed in the audio:

- ☐ When you keep losing the Wi-Fi signal on your phone.
- ☐ When someone leaves a train and doesn't take their garbage.
- ☐ When a website forces you to watch an ad before you can see the content.
- ☐ When you are stuck in traffic on a road that is normally clear.
- ☐ When someone eats something that doesn't smell very nice.
- ☐ When a person nearby is talking loudly on their phone in a quiet space.
- ☐ When your alarm clock isn't loud enough to wake you up.
- ☐ When you are told that your train is going to be late.
- ☐ When someone repeatedly clicks a pen during a meeting.
- ☐ When you can't find a parking spot after driving around for a long time.
- ☐ When you have to listen to someone else's music.
- ☐ When pop-up ads keep appearing on your screen.

How much can science tell us about why we get annoyed?
What are the 3 essential qualities that make something annoying?

Our annoying survey answers

In an online survey, National Geographic asked readers to name their most vexing annoyances by category. Here are some of their responses.

The most annoying technology

Robocalls ... Pop-up ads ... Selfiesticks ... Other people's cell phones ... Electric scooters ... Captchas (typing symbols to prove you're not a robot) ... Virtual assistants like Alexa, Echo, Siri ... "Everything after the wheel."

The most annoying noise

Buzzing insects ... Barking dogs ... Leaf blowers ... Open-mouthed chewing ... Car alarms ... People singing really badly ... Construction ... Entitled people screaming ... Knuckles cracking ... Loud neighbors ... "Being told no."

The most annoying people

Fakers ... Telemarketers who don't stop at the first NO ... TSA agents ... Line cutters ... Narcissists ... Low talkers ... Celebrities ... Bigots.

The most annoying popular expressions

LOL ... Cray cray ... Lean in ... Impactful ... Man up ... My bad ... Fake news ... Could care less ... Woke ... "It is what it is."

The most annoying foods

Stinky cheese ... Okra ... Pizza with pineapple ... Lite beer ... Cilantro ... Black licorice ... "Pumpkin-spiced anything."

I get **annoyed** when...

I **hate** it when...

It **drives me crazy** when...

It's so **irritating** when...

I **can't stand** it when...

It really **bothers** me when...

There's nothing more **frustrating** than when...

It **gets on my nerves** when...

I find it **infuriating** when...

It absolutely **grates on me** when...





What is misophonia?

- 1. What is misophonia? a) Intense sound sensitivity; b) Hearing loss; c) Tinnitus.
- 2. What triggers misophonia? a) Music; b) Silence; c) Mouth sounds.
- 3. Why is there no official diagnosis? a) It's fake; b) It's new; c) It's rare.
- 4. Trigger sounds often come from: a) Close people; b) Strangers; c) TVs.
- 5. Dr. Mattu was triggered by: a) Eating; b) Clicking; c) Flossing.
- 6. His emotional response was: a) Rage; b) Sadness; c) Fear.
- 7. A key piece of advice is to: a) Ignore it; b) Get accommodations; c) Yell.
- 8. Dr. Mattu realized people make sounds: a) On purpose; b) To annoy; c) Unintentionally.



Misophonia

The symptoms of misophonia revolve around how you react to trigger sounds.

Reactions can be:



Emotional feelings like anger.



Body processes like a faster heartbeat.



Behavioral actions like glaring.

Common trigger sounds can be:



Chewing food noisily.



Ticking of a clock.



Heavy breathing.



Tapping fingers or toes.



Clicking a pen.



Water dripping.



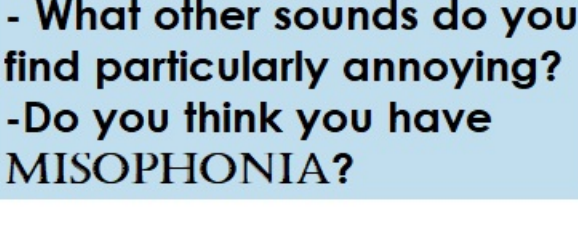
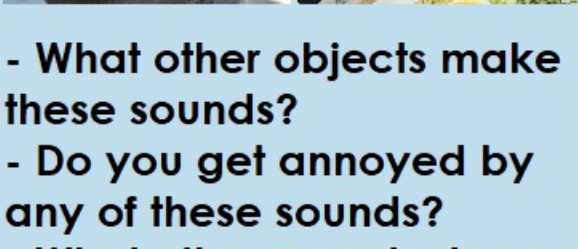
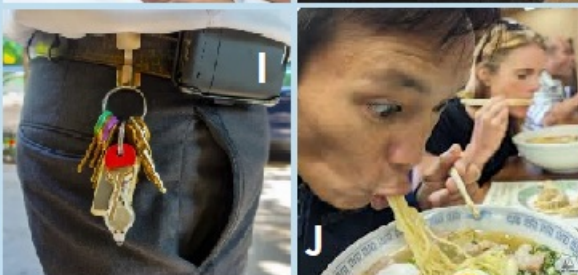
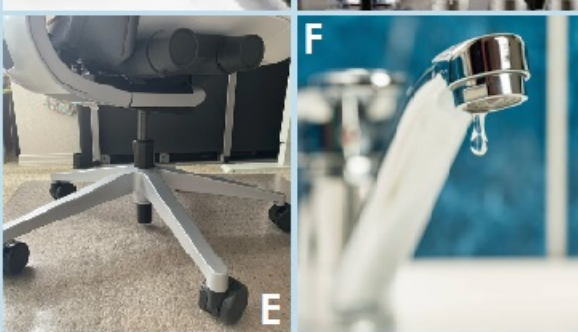
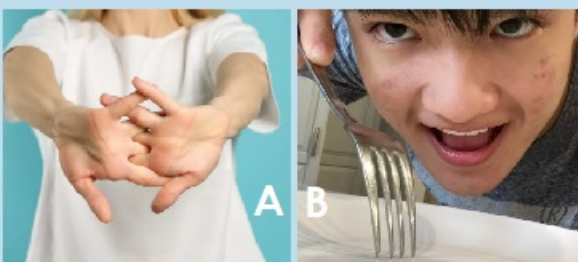
Rustling of paper or plastic.



Smacking lips.

Match the **objects** to the **sounds** they make:

- 1) Buzzing
- 2) Squeaking
- 3) Dripping
- 4) Thumping
- 5) Slurping
- 6) Popping
- 7) Whistling
- 8) Jingling
- 9) Scratching
- 10) Snoring



- What other objects make these sounds?
- Do you get annoyed by any of these sounds?
- What other sounds do you find particularly annoying?
- Do you think you have MISOPHONIA?



WHAT IS THE ANGER ICEBERG THEORY?

a) triggers; b) 90%; c) vulnerable; d) cover; e) secondary; f) anger; g) thoughts; h) projecting

- 1. Dr. Jen explains that _____ is a superficial, or secondary, emotion.
- 2. The majority of an iceberg - _____, is hidden beneath the surface, like our true feelings.
- 3. Embarrassment or fear often aren't safe to express, so anger shows up as a _____.
- 4. She states that _____ always come before feelings.
- 5. In the example, Billy felt _____ and embarrassed in front of his friends.
- 6. By yelling and blaming others, Billy was _____ his anger to hide his true feelings.
- 7. To understand your anger, you need to look for the _____ that set your feelings into motion.
- 8. The anger iceberg theory shows that anger is a _____ emotion that responds to a primary one.

ANGER IS JUST THE TIP OF THE ICEBERG: WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON?

Use the anger iceberg to help you understand the emotions under your anger.

What others see

ANGER

Yelling, sarcasm, irritability, passive-aggression, outbursts, isolation

Shielding feelings

Frustration, resentment, annoyance, bitterness, dismissal

Pain beneath the surface

Hurt, sadness, grief, shame, embarrassment

What's really going on

What we rarely express

Fear, anxiety, helplessness, loneliness, powerlessness

Root Needs Driving It All

I need respect

I need connection

I need control

Think about the last time you got really angry:

- What was your **primary** feeling?
- What **thought** came just before?
- What were you really feeling **underneath**?
- Were you feeling **vulnerable**?
- What was the real **trigger**?
- Were you **embarrassed** or **ashamed**?
- Did you feel **threatened**?
- What feeling were you trying to **cover up**?
- Were you **projecting** your hurt?
- What did you **need** in that moment?

8 Things to Do If You Feel Irritable

Everyone feels irritable sometimes. But if you feel this way often, it can harm your relationships and work. These strategies can help you cope.

1. Acknowledge Your Feelings

Instead of denying you're irritable, admit it to yourself. Naming your feeling can reduce its intensity. You can even rate your irritability from 1 to 10. This simple act can help you feel calmer.



2. Find the Source

Ask yourself why you feel this way. Sometimes the cause is obvious, like stress or hunger. Other times, it might be less clear, like a hormone shift or lack of self-care. Knowing the cause can help you address it.

3. Take Deep Breaths

Irritability causes stress in your body. Slow, deep breaths can calm you down. Try this: inhale slowly for three seconds, hold for one second, and exhale slowly for three seconds. Repeat a few times.



4. Take a Short Break

When you feel irritable, take a time-out. Walk away from the situation. Think of it like recharging your batteries. A short walk or listening to music can help you return feeling refreshed.

5. Get Some Exercise

Physical activity is good for your mental health and can reduce irritability. However, too much exercise can sometimes make it worse. Find a healthy balance that works for you.

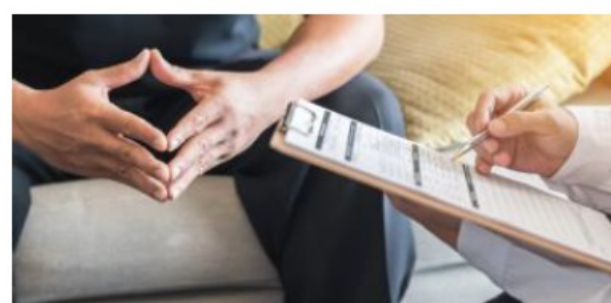


6. Chew Gum

Chewing gum can be a quick way to reduce stress and improve your focus. If you feel irritable, try a piece of gum to help you feel calmer.

7. Change Your Thoughts

Negative thoughts like "This is unbearable!" make irritability worse. Try to reframe your thinking. Focus on the facts instead of your emotions. For example, instead of getting angry about traffic, remind yourself that it is a normal, everyday occurrence.



8. Seek Professional Help

If irritability lasts for more than two weeks, it could be a sign of an underlying issue like depression or anxiety. Talk to a doctor or mental health professional for help.